

MILITARY MIGHT

The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) is developing a number of indigenous weapons, vehicles and systems to keep the citizens of the country safe

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The Indian armed forces, consisting of Army, Navy and Air Force, is among the largest in the world. There is a massive requirement of equipment, vehicles and systems to support their missions and objectives. India currently relies heavily on imports for this, at the moment. To reduce the reliance on imports, the DRDO has undertaken a number of projects to indigenously develop the weapons, vehicles and systems needed. About 300 projects have reached significant milestones in their development in the recent years, and here are a few of them.

MISSILES

A number of missiles for various ranges and purposes have been indigenously developed by DRDO, and inducted into the armed forces. The Agni 5 is an intercontinental ballistic missile with an impressive range of

5,800 kilometres. The primary reason for developing the missile was to act as a nuclear deterrent against China. The missile is capable of being fired from a canister on a mobile platform. The medium range (25 kilometre) Surface-to-Air (SAM) missile Akash, is another success story. The missile has been indigenously developed, and inducted

both into the army and the air force. The DRDO is now working on the Akash New Generation (Akash-NG), with an upgraded and improved range of 50 kilometres.

The Long Range Surface-to-Air Missile (LRSAM) has been developed by the Indian Navy in collaboration with Israel. The missile proved its



An Akash missile being test fired